ONCE

ONCE / concept vision

The Orbital Ark

A modular station of the noosphere, in orbit around the earth.
Each of us keeps a module, each module docks onto the attractors of thought, and together they form a living map of humanity's accumulated wisdom.

Alex Kennedy



The premise

A station gallery of human discovery

The ark is the imagined and digitally emergent spaceship, where objects are attached to information of every kind, where they can be weighed and valued against each other on meritocratic gradients.

Each person curates their module. A garden and gallery of their own informational world.
Expansion becomes a cultivation of quiet attention.

Modules dock onto attractors, attractors gather into stations, and the stations orbit the earth as a map of refining culture in progress.



> “The ark acts as the visible landscape of the collective consciousness. Where ideas and insight find placement in the great cosmic puzzle.”

Cultivation of the subtle sacred

What the feed does

Attention is sold by the second and our data becomes fuel for someone else's targeting. This extraction mentality can engage with us daily without concerted effort to bound it as individuals.

Creators spend most of their energy on promotion, and the work sinks out of view within a day.

This pushes for short sensorial work, rather than concerted effort to make something that lasts.
Less putting up posters in the town square, more inviting others to a party.

What changed

Agents and local AI change how we interact with data.
Personal context now has a clear and immediate value to the person who holds it: a well-kept archive answers you, briefs your agents, finds your collaborators and removes obstacles ahead of time.

Agents also share open ways to plug into context, so a space built today can be read by the tools that arrive next year.
Knowledge curation can become a shared effort so generation of novelty knows exactly where to look.



Anatomy

Five parts, one station

The Station	Attractors dock onto one another and form the ark: a collective cultural architecture, an evolving map of the noosphere rendered as a place you can walk through.
Attractors	Gravitational centres around a question, a field or a purpose. People fill them with what and who they know; tasks, credits and funding gather around them, and stewards hold their rules.
The Arkhive	Films, conversations and sources become connected memory, held in your pod and opened by your cards and permissions. Each experience generates media, and the media carries its provenance wherever it travels.
Boundaries	Trust opens depth. Public, invited and trusted distances mirror the thresholds of a home: people vouch for each other, and you decide what becomes visible at each distance.
Your module	A room you arrange from your work, interests and ideas. It works as memory palace, personality and meeting place at once, with agents that recall context and find the people you should know.

THE ORBITAL ARK

Your work, knowledge and relationships. One space you cultivate.

ONCE / CONCEPT VISION

One Data Layer, Many Ways In.
Choose your view, on any device.

Your Space

Arrange your work, interests and ideas.
Welcome others into your world.

MAKE
DISCUSS
NEXT

Your Agents

Recall context.
Find collaborators.

Trust Opens Depth

People vouch. You choose what becomes visible.

PUBLIC
INVITED
TRUSTED

Shared Attractors

Gather around an interest, question or purpose.
Find people. Join projects. Make things together.

FILM
ECOLOGY
TOOLS
FOUNDATIONS
FRONTIER / OPEN QUESTIONS

Cards Open Stories

Physical symbols of memory,
recognition and access.

LUDIO / THE ORIGINAL MOMENT

Governed & Resourced Together

Stewards hold the rules.
Patronage and shared resources support the work.

The Arkhive

Media, conversations and sources
become connected memory.
Your data. Your permissions.

Explore → Contribute → Be recognised → Open new doors

Films · Studios · Residencies · Gatherings · Cards

Data sovereignty

One data layer, many ways in

Everything you place in the ark lives in one data layer: cards you hold, a pod you control, and permissions you set by the room, the card and the person.

The interface stays separate from the data, so the same structure of information can be walked as a room, read as a map, condensed onto a phone or spoken back as a brief.

Companies and institutions request access to analyse what you choose to share, and offer a service in return.

The Ark acts as broker, while ownership stays with the person. Agents plug into the same layer by permission.



Build approach

Pairing the machines

Every component of the ark already exists as a model or a service.
The work is orchestration: a pipeline that pairs these tools around one shared data layer, so each can be swapped as better models arrive.
While the rooms, cards and memory stay intact.

A room begins as a single rendered view from the doorway. Its surfaces become clickable zones, your media goes onto the walls, and real objects are photographed into reusable 3D pieces.

Movement between rooms starts as a crossfade and grows into flight between modules.



Build a room

Image models such as Krea and Midjourney render the view.



Map the zones

Segmentation turns each object or surface usable.



Furnish it

Vision tagging and a memory graph help placing your media



Go 3D

Image-to-3D and gaussian splats bring in real objects & spaces.



Travel

Video models morph one view into the next.



Translate

Language models condense a room into a map, a list or a prompt.



Read cards

Camera matching from laptops and phones enables a reputational trust network



Orchestrate

Agents tend to our informational architecture, making suggestions, pulling context and reflecting curiosities rooted in truth.

Build approach

A room, built in five moves



Render the view

Map the zones

Furnish it

Link objects

Travel between modules

Cards open stories

A card works like the token of permission you give an agent: it grants access to something specific, and what it opens can be coded after the fact with a simple command.

Offer

A card passes hand to hand at a gathering, a screening or a residency.

Speak

The giver records an intention on their phone, as a small ritual.

Capture

The card is photographed and matched to its artwork and lineage.

Key

It lands in the receiver's sovereign data pod with the key attached.

Photograph the card again, and it finds its transcript, its lineage and the room it opens.
Recognition and access travel with the card as it is gifted through the network, carrying the ark into rooms that have no screens.



From promotion to gardening

The feed	The ark
An algorithm decides what you see	You design what others experience when they find you
Posting into multiple stream	Placing work in a room where it stays
Followers and reach	Trusted network that opens gradual depth
Marketing yourself	Leaving signal & sense-making in the right attractor
Search	Navigation across relationship paths.
Data harvested for targeting	Data held in your pod and lent by permission
Hiring	Attraction to the frontier.



Do the work once. Become the filter for the world.



From the module to the room

This is where the digital populates the real.



Second-order effects

What moves when the medium changes



Advertising

Companies request access to what people choose to share, and offer a service in return. Reach comes from presence inside the attractors where the right people already gather.
A brand can see the reputation a community holds of it, and contributes more to benchmark itself against others.

Communities post and rank ideas that brands can then license.



Academia

Every idea keeps its provenance as it moves between rooms, so citation happens as a matter of course.

Attractors hold foundations at the centre and open questions at the frontier, giving researchers a live map of where their field is moving.

A well-tended attractor grows into a course, then a cohort, then a residency.



Culture

Work placed in the right attractor finds its people through resonance, and makers get their time back from drawn in opportunity.

Recognition travels with the person across communities, so contribution stays portable and projects can fork with their lineage intact.

Economics

Attractors carry their own treasury



Patrons and organisations fund the attractors they care about. The treasury pays for infrastructure, compute and the agent credits of everyone who contributes, so few value players buy their own. Funds are then distributed automatically based on recognition, to contributors and to the stewards who hold the space.

Early backers receive early access to the intelligence and data an attractor produces, so an investment in a field pays off in insight. Stewards hold benefits and obligations, limited by terms, open treasuries and the right to fork, in a way that prevents greed, extraction and corruption.

Revenue lines, proposed



Attractor subscriptions for organisations



Expert-trained agents on command.



Seasons of patronage

Consented context licensing, revenue shared



Hosting, verification and node membership



Films, residencies and studio work from ONCE as 1st attractor.

Path

We build the ark starting with the cockpit



00

Cockpit

A single creator studio pipeline, made public: agents, archive and cards in orchestra, fork-able by any leader.

01

Room builder

Template rooms, clickable zones, placed objects and multi-path travel.
Demand to create arrives with every epic example.

02

First attractors

Invites to potential stewards as ritual recognition of wisdom.
Cards distributed at residencies, screenings and festivals.

03

Network

Attractors dock, fork and fund each other.
Agents arrive through open protocols and bring demand with them.

04

Storyworld

The full station in orbit: film, lore and the ark as a shared game, pulled down into real places.
Communal hyperstition.

The ark begins wherever you are in the smallest of ways. A fractal entry point in space.

Designed in from the start

Where platforms like this fail

An empty station

The cockpit is useful alone. It taps into what once made myspace so successful. Ability to customise/curate your page to show personality, with far less effort.

The virtual world trap

Every room points back to physical places and gatherings. Reinstating what socialising online should be for. To bring us closer to the real and the offline.

Steward capture

Fixed terms, open treasuries and the right to fork with lineage keep each attractor accountable to the people inside it.

Consent overload

Private by design. Three trust distances cover most choices, and finer control stays available for those who want it. Mirroring physical space boundaries.

Spam and fake accounts

Vouching is shared and staked. Every expansion of the network builds node connections. The verifying trust root is witnessed presence at a physical node.

Cards and regulation

Cards carry access, recognition and provenance. Patronage flows to attractors directly, which is then distributed, keeping the card itself a gift.



Where this goes

A starship of life ways

Collecting all treasures for the new world. Every craft, tradition and frontier question held in one navigable place, tended by the people who love it, and read by the intelligence we are raising.



Search becomes navigation

You walk to what you need, through rooms kept by people who know. At its zenith, this replaces the search engine.

Work becomes missions

Attractors post quests, guilds form around them and recognition travels with you. Contribution outgrows the job title.

Creators become cultivators

Work compounds in a garden instead of sinking in a feed. Culture is tended, and it grows season on season.

Intelligence learns from wisdom

Agents read a living map of what humanity values, with provenance, consent and a steward at every door.

Money follows meaning

Patrons fund fields directly. Shifting a cultural paradigm costs far less than a bunker or a space programme.

The station comes down to earth

Studios, residencies and gardens host their own memory. The ideal is pulled down into real towns.

Make the future feel real.

ONCE

Come aboard

Raising £20k to build the cockpit and module builder

Designed by Alex Kennedy, filmmaker, artist and founder of ONCE.

The ark draws in 5 core processes. Worldbuilding, knowledge management, social media production, discussion and memory space.

With production capacity, the studio can offer the space of media expression and adaptive sense-making we are all secretly aching for.

Explore → contribute → push frontier → open new doors

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